
What do you learn and why?

Design powerful learning objectives for your transdisciplinary educational project. Learn how to formulate goals focused on the development of knowledge, skills, and attitudes, and discover how all participants can benefit from this form of education. Use can you frameworks like boundary-crossing skills and Inner Development Goals.

When designing a transdisciplinary educational project, it's important to collectively establish the learning objectives. These objectives or outcomes can relate to personal or professional development in the form of knowledge, skills, attitudes (process goals), or be focused on the outcomes of the project (product goals).

In traditional/monodisciplinary education, the formulation of learning outcomes is centred around the learning process of the student. Working with learning objectives and outcomes is fundamentally tied to student assessment. However, since all partners are learners in a transdisciplinary educational project, it is important to consider the learning objectives and outcomes for all participants.

In the end, the overarching goal of transdisciplinary education is to enable people to contribute to and manage complex societal problems (Veltman et al., 2021). To achieve this, you can formulate various learning objectives or outcomes, for example used on some of the following frameworks.

Boundary-Crossing skills

Boundary-crossing skills are helpful to facilitate collaboration across disciplinary boundaries. These skills support in managing the tensions and challenges that arise when different perspectives and viewpoints come together. Participants practice the recognition, valuing, and utilizing of these tensions to achieve their goals.

Akkerman and Bakker (2011) introduce four learning mechanisms essential for cross-boundary collaboration:

- **Identification:** awareness of your own expertise, assumptions, values, and principles and how these influence your worldview. This helps students with better recognising their own identity, expertise, and values as well as those of others.
- **Coordination:** effective collaboration through organizing meetings, making

work agreements, and communicating effectively.

- **Reflection:** understanding the perspectives of others, which encourage students to broaden their viewpoints and learn from different standpoints.
- **Transformation:** changing your behaviour or practice by being open to other perspectives and expertise. This means the embracement of new concepts, routines, practices, or solutions, and can in the end contribute to the generation of innovative knowledge or solutions.

These learning mechanisms can serve as the foundation when formulating a learning objective or outcome.

Inner Development Goals:

In addition to boundary-crossing skills, there are [Inner Development Goals](#), a framework that contributes to achieving the [Sustainable Development Goals](#) by fostering inner growth for outer change. The framework comprises 23 skills divided into five dimensions:

- **Being:** cultivating our inner life and deepening our relationship with our thoughts, feelings, and body helps us to be present, purposeful, and non-

reactive when facing complexity.

- **Thinking:** developing our cognitive abilities by adopting different perspectives, evaluating information, and understanding the world as an interconnected whole, which is essential for making wise decisions.
- **Relating:** valuing, caring for, and feeling connected to others, such as neighbours, future generations, or the biosphere, which helps us to create fairer and more sustainable systems and societies for everyone.
- **Collaborating:** to make progress on shared issues, we need to develop our abilities to give space, be inclusive, and communicate with stakeholders with different values, skills, and competencies.
- **Acting:** qualities like courage and optimism help us to achieve real agency, break old patterns, generate original ideas, and act with perseverance in uncertain times.

These inner development goals can be an outcome of transdisciplinary education.

Here is a [Dutch] video on insights into Inner Development Goals:

Solutions to complex problems are provisional and need continuous adjustment. Align the expectations about learning objectives and outcomes with this reality. Goals or outcomes focused on the project's solution are less suitable than those focused on the unpredictable process (Veltman, 2021).